

GOOGLE VIDS FREE-TIER VIDEO LAB

Create a polished mini video without burning AI credits

Class goal: students create a short, professional-looking Google Vids video using school Workspace access, stock media, text, timing, animations, transitions, and optional self-recorded narration — without relying on paid AI-generation credits.

Direct links: **Use your school Google account.** [Open Google Vids](#) | [Google Vids product page](#) | [Google Workspace Learning Center](#)

Time	45-60 minutes
Difficulty	Beginner-friendly
Required tool	Google Vids, using your school Google Workspace account
Deliverable	A 20-40 second mini video with 3 scenes, captions/text, animations, transitions, and a shareable link or exported file
Free-tier strategy	Do not use Veo, AI Avatar, or Lyria unless your instructor confirms your school account includes them. This lab is built around stock media and manual editing so the class does not run out of credits.

Why this version uses Google Vids differently

The problem we are solving: Many AI video tools feel magical until the class hits credit limits or long render queues. Google Vids can still feel impressive because it combines a video editor, stock media, text design, timing, animations, transitions, recording, and Workspace sharing in one place. This lab keeps the magic but avoids the credit trap.

Rule for today: Build like a video editor, not like a credit spender. Use stock video, text, timing, transitions, and optional self-recorded voice. Save AI-generation features for demos or optional homework.

What students will create

Students will create a short video called:

My Dream Space: A 30-Second Open House Tour

The final video will not require AI-generated video clips. Instead, students will combine stock footage, text overlays, scene timing, animations, and transitions to create the feeling of a polished real-estate or lifestyle micro-video.

Scene	Visual idea	Text overlay	Editing skill learned
1	Exterior / skyline / beautiful house-like setting	Welcome to my dream space	Stock search + title text + scene length
2	Interior / living room / hallway / studio	Three things this space gives me	Split-screen, timing bars, animations
3	Deck / garden / sunset / peaceful outdoor setting	A place to think, create, and build	Transitions + final call-to-action

Part 1 — Access Google Vids with your school account

Use your school organization account, not a personal Gmail account. Your school may include access through Google Workspace. If you cannot see Vids, do not buy anything; tell your instructor.

1. Open Chrome or another desktop browser. Google Vids creation is designed for desktop editing, not phone editing.
2. Go to <https://vids.google.com/> and sign in using your school Google account.
3. If the direct link does not work, go to [google.com](https://www.google.com), sign in, click the nine-dot Google Apps menu in the upper-right corner, and look for Vids.
4. If you see buttons such as Upgrade, Trial, AI Avatar, Lyria, or Veo and they ask for payment or premium access, skip them for this lab.
5. Choose Blank vid. This keeps us inside the free, reliable editor workflow.

Instructor checkpoint: Before students start, ask everyone to raise a hand if Vids opens successfully. Pair students who cannot access Vids with a partner, or have them storyboard on paper while their partner edits.

Part 2 — Rename the project and understand the layout

6. In the upper-left corner, click Untitled video.
7. Rename it: My Dream Space — [Your First Name].
8. Notice the main canvas in the center. This is like a slide, but it plays as video.
9. Notice the timeline at the bottom. This controls scene order and duration.
10. Notice the right-side tools, such as Stock, Text, Record, and other options depending on your school account.

Simple analogy: Google Vids is like Google Slides plus a video timeline. Each scene is like a slide; timing, animations, and transitions make it feel like a video.

Part 3 — Create Scene 1: The opening shot

Scene 1 should feel like the opening of a stylish home-tour show. We are not trying to create a real mansion. We are trying to create a mood: polished, aspirational, welcoming.

11. Click Stock on the right-side panel.
12. Choose Videos, not Images, if that option appears.
13. Search for one of these terms: modern house, luxury home, beautiful home, city sunset, architecture, front door, peaceful neighborhood.
14. Preview a clip by clicking the eye or preview icon if available.
15. Select a clip and click Insert.
16. If the clip does not fill the full scene, right-click it and choose an option similar to Expand video to fill scene or resize it manually until it fills the canvas.
17. Click Text and choose Add a title.
18. Type: Welcome to My Dream Space.
19. Make the title large, readable, and centered. Use strong contrast so it is visible on top of the video.

20. In the timeline, shorten Scene 1 to about 5 seconds.

COPY / PASTE TEXT FOR SCENE 1 TITLE

Welcome to My Dream Space
A 30-second open-house style tour

Preview Scene 1. It should immediately tell the viewer what the video is about. If the text is hard to read, add a darker rectangle behind the text, change the text color, or choose a simpler background clip.

Part 4 — Create Scene 2: The “three reasons” split-screen scene

Scene 2 is where the video becomes more than pretty footage. It gives the viewer a reason to care. The presenter in the tutorial demonstrated a useful trick: place moving video on one side and text facts on the other side. This keeps the screen active without making the viewer dizzy.

21. Click the plus icon at the bottom to create a new scene.
22. Click Stock > Videos.
23. Search for living room, hallway, interior design, cozy home, modern apartment, home office, or elegant interior.
24. Insert a clip.
25. Resize or crop the video so it fills only the right half of the screen. Leave the left half open for text.
26. Click Text and add three separate text boxes. Do not put all three ideas in one text box.
27. Put one short statement in each text box.
28. Select the three text boxes. Use Arrange > Align > Left so the text lines up cleanly.
29. With the same text boxes selected, use Arrange > Distribute > Vertically so the spacing looks professional.
30. Set the scene duration to about 8-10 seconds.

COPY / PASTE TEXT FOR SCENE 2

A place to focus
A place to recharge
A place to create

Part 5 — Timing: make the three lines appear one by one

This is the moment when the project starts to feel like real video editing. Timing is not decoration. Timing tells the viewer where to look.

31. Click Show timing. You should see timing bars for the objects in the scene.
32. Find the timing bar for the first text box. Make it appear near the beginning of the scene.
33. Find the timing bar for the second text box. Start it about 2 seconds later.
34. Find the timing bar for the third text box. Start it about 2 seconds after the second.
35. Preview the scene. The viewer should read one idea, then the next, then the next.

Part 6 — Animations: make the text feel smooth

36. Click the first text box.
37. Click the animation icon or animation menu.
38. Choose Fade. Fade is simple, clean, and professional.
39. Apply Fade to the second and third text boxes.
40. If you see an option called Separate enter and exit animations, turn it on.
41. Keep Enter animation as Fade.
42. Set Exit animation to None. This prevents the text from awkwardly disappearing before the viewer has finished reading it.
43. Preview again.

Beginner rule: use simple animations. A clean fade usually looks more professional than bounce, spin, or dramatic zoom.

Part 7 — Create Scene 3: The peaceful ending

44. Click the plus icon to create a third scene.
45. Click Stock > Videos.
46. Search for garden, deck, balcony view, sunset garden, backyard, landscape, peaceful nature, or city balcony.
47. Insert the best clip you can find.
48. Add a short closing statement as a title or subtitle.
49. Set the scene duration to about 7 seconds.
50. Add a second line at the bottom: Built in Google Vids.

COPY / PASTE TEXT FOR SCENE 3

This is where ideas become real.
Built in Google Vids.

Part 8 — Add transitions between scenes

Hard cuts can feel abrupt. Transitions are like hallway doors between rooms. You do not need fancy transitions; you just need smooth ones.

51. Look between Scene 1 and Scene 2 in the timeline.
52. Click the transition icon between the scenes.
53. Choose Dissolve or Fade.
54. Set a short duration. Around 0.4 to 0.8 seconds is usually enough.
55. Repeat between Scene 2 and Scene 3.
56. Preview the full video from the beginning.

Professional habit: one transition style is usually enough. If every scene uses a different transition, the video starts to look like a middle-school PowerPoint from 2003. Funny, but not the goal.

Part 9 — Add narration without using paid AI voice credits

The tutorial mentions AI voiceovers and premium AI tools. For this free-plan classroom version, students should use their own voice, screen/camera recording, or skip narration entirely. This avoids premium features and keeps the lab reliable.

57. Click Record if available.
58. Choose audio-only, camera, or screen/camera depending on the options you see.
59. Read the short script below. Speak slowly and naturally.
60. Insert the recording into the video.
61. If recording is unavailable, simply keep the video silent or use background music from the stock library if your school account allows it.

COPY / PASTE / READ ALOUD SCRIPT

Welcome to my dream space.
This is a place to focus, recharge, and create.
It is not just a beautiful space. It is a place where ideas become real.

Part 10 — Final polish checklist

Check	What to look for	Done?
Text readability	Can I read every word quickly?	
Timing	Do text elements appear in a logical order?	
Scene length	Is each scene short enough to keep attention?	
Transitions	Do scenes move smoothly without feeling cheesy?	
Audio	If narration is included, is it understandable?	
Credits	Did I avoid premium AI tools unless the instructor approved them?	
Sharing	Can my instructor open the link or file?	

Part 11 — Share or export your video

62. Click Share, Export, or Download depending on what your school account shows.
63. If sharing by link, set permissions exactly as your instructor requests. Usually this means anyone in the school organization with the link can view.
64. If exporting, save the video file and upload it to the course site.
65. Submit your link or file plus a one-sentence reflection.

EXIT TICKET

My video is about: _____
The best visual choice I made was: _____
One editing technique I learned was: _____
One thing I would improve next time is: _____

Optional Extension — only if your instructor confirms your account includes it

Some accounts may show Veo, AI Avatar, Lyria, or Help me create. These features can be impressive, but they may be premium or limited. Do not use them in class unless your instructor explicitly says the school account includes them and there is enough quota for everyone.

OPTIONAL VEO PROMPT — DO NOT USE UNLESS APPROVED

Create an 8-second cinematic shot of a modern dream home at sunset. The camera slowly glides toward the front entrance. Warm golden light reflects on glass windows. The mood is elegant, peaceful, and welcoming. No people. No text on screen.

Instructor notes

- This lab intentionally avoids credit-heavy AI generation. It is designed to work even when students have limited or no AI video credits.
- The learning outcome is not “make the most advanced AI video.” The outcome is “understand video storytelling, scene structure, timing, animation, transitions, and export/share workflow.”
- If some students do not have access to Google Vids, pair them with classmates or have them complete the storyboard and script portions as a backup deliverable.
- The three-scene structure keeps the project short enough for class time but polished enough to feel satisfying.

Mini-rubric

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Needs work
Story flow	Clear beginning, middle, and ending	Mostly clear sequence	Scenes feel disconnected
Visual design	Readable text and strong layout	Mostly readable	Text/layout difficult to follow
Editing craft	Good timing, animations, and transitions	Some timing/transition work	Little editing beyond inserting clips
Free-tier discipline	Avoids premium tools and stays within instructions	Minor confusion but no major issue	Uses restricted/premium tools without approval
Reflection	Specific, thoughtful explanation	Basic explanation	Missing or vague reflection

References and source notes

- Google Vids product page: <https://workspace.google.com/products/vids/>
- Google Vids sign-in: <https://vids.google.com/>
- Google Workspace Learning Center: <https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/15136434>
- User-provided Google Vids tutorial transcript: “Pasted text(1).txt” uploaded in this chat.